

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Feminism, Sex and Gender - Complete Topic Package

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Feminism, Sex and Gender - Complete Topic Package	5
DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT	5
BASIC LEARNING SESSION	5
SESSION 1 - Patriarchy, Feminism and the Central Political Question	5
SESSION 2 - Sex, Gender and the Social Construction of Hierarchy	7
SESSION 3 - Core Distinctions, Thinkers and Feminist Streams	8
SESSION 4 - Illustrations, Comparative Matrix and Trap Repair	9
SESSION 5 - Ownership Boundaries, Revision Spine and Source Discipline	10
SESSION 6 - Later Provenance and Marxist Feminism	11
SESSION 7 - Pateman and Okin: Contract, Justice and the Family	12
SESSION 8 - Butler, Performativity and Intersectionality	13
SESSION 9 - Objection-Reply Chains and Cautious Indian Application	14
SESSION 10 - Directive Decoding and Mark-Scaled Answer Architecture	15
COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM	17
BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION	22
Practice design	22
MCQ 1	22
MCQ 2	22
MCQ 3	23
MCQ 4	23
MCQ 5	23
MCQ 6	24
MCQ 7	24
MCQ 8	25
MCQ 9	25
MCQ 10	26
MCQ 11	26
MCQ 12	27
MCQ 13	27

MCQ 14	28
MCQ 15	28
MCQ 16	29
MCQ 17	29
MCQ 18	30
MCQ 19	30
MCQ 20	31
MCQ 21	31
MCQ 22	32
MCQ 23	32
MCQ 24	33
MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL	33
MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL	34
MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL	34
MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL	35
MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL	35
MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL	36
MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL	36
MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL	37
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	37
VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS	37
ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS	37
Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks	37
Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks	38
Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks	38
Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks	39
Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks	40
Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks	40
OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER	41
1. One-screen advanced map	41
2. Scope, assumptions and conceptual boundary	41
3. Direct-book argument reconstruction	42

4. Definitions and distinctions	42
5. Thinker-by-thinker positions	42
6. Competing perspectives	42
7. Internal debates and criticisms	43
8. Comparative matrix	43
9. Application without current-affairs dependence	43
10. UPSC answer-engine prompts	43
11. Cross-links and exclusions	44
12. Factual-risk checks	44
13. Sources, metadata and tags	44
CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES	44
GS ownership and final answer route	46

Feminism, Sex and Gender - Complete Topic Package

Subject: Political Theory **Section:** Subject-wide Syllabus **Target stages:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only **Primary ownership:** GS-II conceptual foundations **Cross-application:** GS-I, GS-IV and Essay only where genuinely relevant **Classification firewall:** Political Theory is a GS/Prelims foundation, not a separate UPSC paper. **Source policy:** complete Basic owner first; Advanced enrichment only after practice.

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

- **Core scope:** patriarchy, sex/gender and liberal, radical and socialist feminism.
- **Source rule:** canonical Basic/Core, Advanced, assembled package, official GS mapping, routed Prelims/GS ledgers and OCR-searchable local books were reconciled before repair.
- **PYQ rule:** only directly verified Prelims/GS Mains questions may be owned; when none exists, original GS practice is labelled honestly.
- **Writing rule:** claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification/link to demand.
- **Advanced rule:** OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH means enrichment beyond a core GS answer and never a separate-paper classification.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

SESSION 1 - Patriarchy, Feminism and the Central Political Question

Subject: Political Theory | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **Exam relevance:** GS-II (Polity & Governance) conceptual foundation; GS-II conceptual foundation. **Core area:** Feminist critique of patriarchy through the distinction between biological sex and socially constructed gender. **Grounded in:** O. P. Gauba, *An Introduction to Political Theory*, Fifth Edition (2009), Ch.2, PDF pp.84-93. **Source edition/cutoff:** Fifth Edition (2009); no post-2009 fact is assumed unless independently dated and tagged CURRENT:. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference/synthesis | **CURRENT:** = dated current anchor | **WRONG:** = trap/misattribution. *Companion:* Political-Theory/advanced/06_Feminism-Sex-and-Gender.md.

1. One-screen conceptual map

patriarchy
->
women's inferior status is social, not naturally justified
->
sex = biological difference
gender = cultural role/status construction
->
feminist critique
->
liberal feminism / radical feminism / socialist feminism
->
equal status + transformed social relations

- **FACT:** Gauba treats feminism as a protest against the inferior status assigned to women by patriarchy, not as a denial that biological differences exist. (PDF pp.84-86)

2. Why this topic matters

- **FACT:** The topic teaches how power can operate through family roles, labour division, culture and political exclusion, not only through law or property. (PDF pp.85-87)
- **FACT:** The sex-gender distinction is central for answering why inequality can be socially constructed even when biological difference is real. (PDF pp.84-86)
- **FACT:** The three streams of feminism provide a compact framework for PSIR and GS-II answers on equality, citizenship and justice. (PDF pp.88-90)

2A. Origin and timeline of feminism, sex and gender

FACT: The dated spine below is taken directly from the routed pages (gauba PDF pp.84-93) rather than from earlier notes. **ANALYSIS:** Chronology matters here because a Political Theory answer that names a position without the work or the period behind it reads as assertion; naming the anchor converts the same sentence into evidence.

Dated rail drawn from the routed source pages (each row reproduces a name, life-date, work or event exactly as the local source records it):

Anchor	Name, work or event	What the source attaches to it
1755	FACT: A Discourse on the Origin of Inequality	Rousseau (1712-78) in his essay A Discourse on the Origin of Inequality (1755) had distinguished between natural inequality and conventional inequality
1759-97	FACT: Mary Wollstonecraft	In Britain, free-thinking women like Mary Wollstonecraft (1759-97) and Harriet Taylor (1807- 59) made a fervent appeal for equal rights of women
1759-97	FACT: Theory When Mary Wollstonecraft	Early voices demanding rights of women particularly focused on these questions. 74 An Introduction to Political Theory When Mary Wollstonecraft (1759-97) published her essay Vindication of the Rights of Woman (1792), woman was not only restrained from voting, but was deemed unfit for education, was ...
1792	FACT: Vindication of the Rights of Woman	Early voices demanding rights of women particularly focused on these questions. 74 An Introduction to Political Theory When Mary Wollstonecraft (1759-97) published her essay Vindication of the Rights of Woman (1792), woman was not only restrained from voting, but was deemed unfit for education, was ...
1806-73	FACT: John Stuart Mill	Later, John Stuart Mill (1806- 73), in his essay on The Subjection of Women (1869) argued that women were by no means less talented than men and hence deserved equal rights with men
1807-59	FACT: Harriet Taylor	In Britain, free-thinking women like Mary Wollstonecraft (1759-97) and Harriet Taylor (1807- 59) made a fervent appeal for equal rights of women
1869	FACT: The Subjection of Women	Later, John Stuart Mill (1806- 73), in his essay on The Subjection of Women (1869) argued that women were by no means less talented than men and hence deserved equal rights with men
1970	FACT: The Dialectic of Sex	RADICAL FEMINISM Its chief spokesperson Shulamith Firestone (1945-) in her celebrated work The Dialectic of Sex (1970) argued that women's subordination could not be understood Concept of Ideology 75 as a symptom or aspect of some deeper or more comprehensive system of domination, such as racism ...
1971	FACT: Sexual Politics	Kate Millett (1934-) in Sexual Politics (1971) argued that the relationship between the sexes was based on power and further sustained by an ideology
1972	FACT: Women, Resistance and Revolution	In her best-known historical writings - Women, Resistance and Revolution (1972) and Hidden from History (1973) - Rowbotham tried to reclaim the past for women as a source of knowledge and strength that could contribute to their present struggle
1973	FACT: Hidden from History	In her best-known historical writings - Women, Resistance and Revolution (1972) and Hidden from History (1973) - Rowbotham tried to reclaim the past for women as a source of knowledge and strength that could contribute to their present struggle

Anchor	Name, work or event	What the source attaches to it
1989	FACT: She continued this approach in The Past is before Us	She continued this approach in The Past is before Us (1989)

ANALYSIS: Dating discipline: use only the anchors in this rail. Do not attach a year to a name the source leaves undated, and do not convert a 2009-edition chronology into a claim about later scholarship.

Visual-first recall

PATRIARCHY, FEMINISM AND THE CENTRAL POLITICAL QUESTION

- |
- [1] Gauba treats feminism as a protest against the inferior status assigned to women by...
- ▼
- [2] The topic teaches how power can operate through family roles, labour division,...
- ▼
- [3] The sex-gender distinction is central for answering why inequality can be socially...
- ▼
- [4] The three streams of feminism provide a compact framework for PSIR and GS-II answers...

Answer-grabbing line: Gauba treats feminism as a protest against the inferior status assigned to women by patriarchy, not as a denial that biological differences exist. (PDF pp.84-86)

Must-write keywords: Subject;; Tier;; Exam relevance;; Core area;; Grounded in;; Source edition/cutoff;; Patriarchy.

Claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification demonstration

Claim: Gauba treats feminism as a protest against the inferior status assigned to women by patriarchy, not as a denial that biological differences exist. (PDF pp.84-86) **Named evidence/example:** The topic teaches how power can operate through family roles, labour division, culture and political exclusion, not only through law or property. (PDF pp.85-87) **Analysis:** Read together, these propositions show how patriarchy, feminism and the central political question shapes feminism, sex and gender rather than serving as a detachable list of names. **Qualification:** Gauba treats feminism as a protest against the inferior status assigned to women by patriarchy, not as a denial that biological differences exist. (PDF pp.84-86)

SESSION 2 - Sex, Gender and the Social Construction of Hierarchy

3. Essential definitions

- FACT: **Feminism:** concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex. (PDF p.84)
- FACT: **Patriarchy:** literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life. (PDF p.84)
- FACT: **Sex:** biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics. (PDF p.84)
- FACT: **Gender:** culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men. (PDF pp.84-85)
- FACT: **Gender inequality:** a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change. (PDF p.86)
- FACT: **Feminist theory:** advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society. (PDF p.86)

4. Core argument / chapter spine

- FACT: Gauba starts by defining feminism as resistance to unjust female subordination produced by patriarchy. (PDF p.84)
- FACT: He then distinguishes sex from gender so that biological difference is separated from socially assigned inferiority. (PDF pp.84-86)
- FACT: Gender roles such as aggressiveness/dominance for men and submissiveness/expressiveness for women are treated as cultural instruments of social control. (PDF p.85)
- FACT: Gauba argues that biological differences do not justify inferior status for women; the main causes lie in social arrangements and cultural conditioning. (PDF pp.86-87)

- FACT: He ends by classifying feminism into liberal, radical and socialist streams. (PDF pp.88-90)

Visual-first recall

SEX, GENDER AND THE SOCIAL CONSTRUCTION OF HIERARCHY

- |
- [1] Feminism: concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with...
- v
- [2] Patriarchy: literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in...
- v
- [3] Sex: biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary...
- v
- [4] Gender: culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached...

Answer-grabbing line: Feminism: concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex. (PDF p.84)

Must-write keywords: Feminism;; Patriarchy;; Sex;; Gender;; Gender inequality;; Feminist theory;; Gender.

Claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification demonstration

Claim: Feminism: concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex. (PDF p.84) **Named evidence/example:** Patriarchy: literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life. (PDF p.84) **Analysis:** Read together, these propositions show how sex, gender and the social construction of hierarchy shapes feminism, sex and gender rather than serving as a detachable list of names. **Qualification:** Gender inequality: a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change. (PDF p.86)

SESSION 3 - Core Distinctions, Thinkers and Feminist Streams

5. Essential distinctions

- FACT: **Sex vs gender:** sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social. (PDF pp.84-86)
- FACT: **Natural inequality vs conventional inequality:** Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category. (PDF p.86)
- FACT: **Legal equality vs substantive equality:** early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power. (PDF pp.88-91)
- FACT: **Equal treatment vs compensatory support:** Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures. (PDF pp.92-93)
- WRONG: **Biology justifies hierarchy:** Gauba explicitly rejects this. (PDF pp.86-87)

6. Thinkers and positions

- FACT: **Mary Wollstonecraft:** argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing. (PDF p.88)
- FACT: **J.S. Mill:** argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights. (PDF pp.84, 88)
- FACT: **Liberal feminism:** seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation. (PDF p.88)
- FACT: **Shulamith Firestone:** radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological change. (PDF p.89)
- FACT: **Kate Millett:** radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology. (PDF p.89)
- FACT: **Sheila Rowbotham:** socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions. (PDF pp.89-90)

Visual-first recall

CORE DISTINCTIONS, THINKERS AND FEMINIST STREAMS

- |
- [1] Sex vs gender: sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social. (PDF pp.84-86)
- v
- [2] Natural inequality vs conventional inequality: Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to...
- v
- [3] Legal equality vs substantive equality: early feminism attacked barriers to...
- v
- [4] Equal treatment vs compensatory support: Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting...

Answer-grabbing line: Sex vs gender: sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social. (PDF pp.84-86)

Must-write keywords: Sex vs gender;; Natural inequality vs conventional inequality;; Legal equality vs substantive equality;; Equal treatment vs compensatory support;; Biology justifies hierarchy;; Mary Wollstonecraft;; J.S. Mill:.

Claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification demonstration

Claim: Sex vs gender: sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social. (PDF pp.84-86) **Named evidence/example:** Natural inequality vs conventional inequality: Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category. (PDF p.86) **Analysis:** Read together, these propositions show how core distinctions, thinkers and feminist streams shapes feminism, sex and gender rather than serving as a detachable list of names. **Qualification:** Biology justifies hierarchy: Gauba explicitly rejects this. (PDF pp.86-87)

SESSION 4 - Illustrations, Comparative Matrix and Trap Repair

7. Illustrative examples

- FACT: Gauba's examples of girls being socialized toward obedience and boys toward assertiveness show how gender roles are culturally produced. (PDF p.87)
- FACT: The early rights agenda focused on education, property, divorce and suffrage because these exclusions had no necessary connection with female biology. (PDF pp.87-88)
- ANALYSIS: A safe classroom example is to contrast biological maternity with culturally assigned ideas that women must therefore remain outside public life.
- WRONG: Gauba's cited 1980 UN numerical claim and the follow-up line saying the condition remained unchanged should never be repeated as current fact; at most they are dated book-period illustrations. (PDF p.86)

8. Comparison table

Stream	Core claim	Main obstacle identified	Remedy emphasized
Liberal feminism	FACT: Women deserve equal opportunity and equal rights in all walks of life. (PDF p.88)	FACT: Formal legal, educational and professional barriers. (PDF pp.88-89)	FACT: Equal pay, representation, reform of discriminatory laws. (PDF p.88)
Radical feminism	FACT: Women's oppression is primary and cannot be reduced to some deeper system alone. (PDF p.89)	FACT: Patriarchal sexual power and reproductive dependence. (PDF p.89)	FACT: Transform sex-power relations and dismantle domination. (PDF p.89)
Socialist feminism	FACT: Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism. (PDF pp.89-90)	FACT: Wage labour, domestic labour and class exploitation together. (PDF pp.89-90)	FACT: Link women's liberation with broader anti-capitalist and anti-oppression struggles. (PDF p.90)

9. UPSC traps and corrections

- WRONG: **Sex and gender mean the same thing.** -> FACT: Gauba makes the distinction foundational: sex is biological, gender is cultural. (PDF pp.84-86)
- WRONG: **All feminism says women are biologically determined.** -> FACT: Firestone's reproductive-biology argument is one radical-feminist position, not feminism's consensus. (PDF p.89)
- WRONG: **If women receive equal legal rights, feminism has no further issue.** -> FACT: Gauba shows later feminism asking about representation, social status and unequal participation in public power. (PDF pp.91-93)

- **WRONG: Old statistics in the book can be quoted as present reality.** -> **WRONG:** The 1980 UN figure and book-era representation data are historical and must not be presented as current fact. (PDF pp.86, 91-93)

Visual-first recall

ILLUSTRATIONS, COMPARATIVE MATRIX AND TRAP REPAIR

- |
- [1] Gauba's examples of girls being socialized toward obedience and boys toward...
- v
- [2] The early rights agenda focused on education, property, divorce and suffrage because...
- v
- [3] A safe classroom example is to contrast biological maternity with culturally assigned...
- v
- [4] Gauba's cited 1980 UN numerical claim and the follow-up line saying the condition...

Answer-grabbing line: Gauba's examples of girls being socialized toward obedience and boys toward assertiveness show how gender roles are culturally produced. (PDF p.87)

Must-write keywords: Sex and gender mean the same thing.; All feminism says women are biologically determined.; If women receive equal legal rights, feminism has no further issue.; Old statistics in the book can be quoted as present reality.; Illustrations; Comparative Matrix; Trap Repair.

Claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification demonstration

Claim: Gauba's examples of girls being socialized toward obedience and boys toward assertiveness show how gender roles are culturally produced. (PDF p.87) **Named evidence/example:** The early rights agenda focused on education, property, divorce and suffrage because these exclusions had no necessary connection with female biology. (PDF pp.87-88) **Analysis:** Read together, these propositions show how illustrations, comparative matrix and trap repair shapes feminism, sex and gender rather than serving as a detachable list of names. **Qualification:** Stream - Core claim - Main obstacle identified - Remedy emphasized

SESSION 5 - Ownership Boundaries, Revision Spine and Source Discipline

10. Cross-links and boundaries

- **FACT:** Read the deeper companion at `Political-Theory/advanced/06_Feminism-Sex-and-Gender.md`.
- **FACT:** Use `Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md` for the ideology matrix and anti-caricature guidance on feminism.
- **FACT:** Use `Political-Theory/README.md` for the module map linking feminism to state, power, citizenship and justice.
- **FACT:** For cross-syllabus support, use `Philosophy/paper-2/socio-political/Gender-Discrimination.md`.
- **FACT:** For constitutional-equality application, move outward to `Polity/advanced/07_Fundamental-Rights.md`.
- **FACT:** Topic-map continuities especially matter with
`Political-Theory/basic/13_Diverse-Perspectives-on-the-State.md` (feminist state),
`Political-Theory/basic/15_Power-Authority-and-Legitimacy.md` (gendered power),
`Political-Theory/basic/16_Citizenship-and-Its-Critiques.md` (feminist citizenship) and
`Political-Theory/basic/20_Diverse-Perspectives-on-Justice.md` (feminist justice).

11. Revision capsule / answer spine

- **FACT:** Begin with feminism as protest against patriarchy. (PDF p.84)
- **FACT:** Define sex and gender separately and sharply. (PDF pp.84-86)
- **FACT:** Use Rousseau's natural/conventional inequality distinction to show why gender hierarchy is alterable. (PDF p.86)
- **FACT:** Note that biological differences do not justify inferior status. (PDF pp.86-87)
- **FACT:** Classify feminism into liberal, radical and socialist streams with one thinker each. (PDF pp.88-90)
- **FACT:** End by warning against using Gauba's dated numerical claims as present-day evidence. (PDF pp.86, 91-93)

12. Sources, metadata and tags

- FACT: Primary source used directly: O. P. Gauba, *An Introduction to Political Theory*, Fifth Edition (2009), Ch.2, PDF pp.84-93.
- FACT: Key anchors: feminism, patriarchy, sex-gender distinction (PDF pp.84-86); socialization and inequality (PDF pp.86-87); Wollstonecraft, Mill and three streams of feminism (PDF pp.88-90).
- ANALYSIS: Tags: #PoliticalTheory #Feminism #Patriarchy #SexAndGender #LiberalFeminism #RadicalFeminism #SocialistFeminism.

Visual-first recall

OWNERSHIP BOUNDARIES, REVISION SPINE AND SOURCE DISCIPLINE

- |
- [1] Read the deeper companion at Political-Theory/advanced/06_Feminism-Sex-and-Gender.md.
- ▼
- [2] Use Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md for the ideology matrix and anti-...
- ▼
- [3] Use Political-Theory/README.md for the module map linking feminism to state, power,...
- ▼
- [4] For cross-syllabus support, use Philosophy/paper-2/socio-political/Gender-...

Answer-grabbing line: Read the deeper companion at Political-Theory/advanced/06_Feminism-Sex-and-Gender.md.

Must-write keywords: Ownership Boundaries; Revision Spine; Source Discipline; SESSION; Cross-links; Read; Political-Theory.

Claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification demonstration

Claim: Read the deeper companion at Political-Theory/advanced/06_Feminism-Sex-and-Gender.md. **Named evidence/example:** Use Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md for the ideology matrix and anti-caricature guidance on feminism. **Analysis:** Read together, these propositions show how ownership boundaries, revision spine and source discipline shapes feminism, sex and gender rather than serving as a detachable list of names. **Qualification:** For constitutional-equality application, move outward to Polity/advanced/07_Fundamental-Rights.md.

SESSION 6 - Later Provenance and Marxist Feminism

13. Provenance beyond Gauba: sex/gender, standpoint and later feminist theory (extension - use with caution)

- ANALYSIS: Gauba's chapter grounds the sex/gender distinction and the liberal/radical/socialist typology; it does **not** itself discuss Simone de Beauvoir, Gayle Rubin, Ann Oakley, Carole Pateman, Susan Moller Okin, Judith Butler or Kimberle Crenshaw. Everything below is a standard PSIR/political-theory extension used by examiners beyond this specific book, flagged ANALYSIS: throughout, and is not tied to a page number in the primary source.
- ANALYSIS: **Simone de Beauvoir** (*The Second Sex*, 1949) supplies the founding proposition - paraphrased, not quoted verbatim here since exact wording is not independently verified in this file's source base - that womanhood is a social becoming rather than a fixed biological given. Use this as the philosophical root of the sex/gender split that Gauba later states in textbook form.
- ANALYSIS: **Ann Oakley** (*Sex, Gender and Society*, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology.
- ANALYSIS: **Gayle Rubin** ("The Traffic in Women", 1975) supplies the mechanism often paired with the distinction: the "sex/gender system" - social arrangements that transform biological sex into a hierarchy of gendered obligation, kinship exchange and constrained sexuality. Rubin explains *how* sex becomes gender, which Gauba's chapter asserts but does not mechanise.
- ANALYSIS: Caveat: cite these three names as standard provenance for the sex/gender distinction, but do not present a single, uncontested "origin story" as settled fact - the distinction has multiple co-formulators and was consolidated gradually; avoid taxonomic overclaim.

Marxist feminism, reconstructed separately from socialist feminism

- **ANALYSIS:** This basic file (like Gauba) uses "socialist feminism" as the umbrella term (Rowbotham) for the patriarchy-plus-capitalism synthesis. Marxist feminism is a related but analytically prior strand a strong answer should distinguish:
- **Claim:** women's oppression is generated principally by the capitalist mode of production, especially unpaid domestic/reproductive labour that reproduces the workforce free of charge.
- **Evidence:** the 1970s "domestic labour debate" treated housework as unwaged labour-power reproduction necessary for capital accumulation.
- **Significance:** relocates the "private" household inside political economy, making family labour a class question, not only a cultural one.
- **Limit:** a pure class-reduction cannot explain patriarchal violence or control of sexuality that predates and outlasts capitalism - which is exactly why Rowbotham's socialist-feminist synthesis treats patriarchy and capitalism as two distinct, mutually reinforcing systems rather than one reducible to the other.
- **ANALYSIS:** Exam use: if a question specifically says "Marxist feminism," lead with the domestic-labour/social-reproduction claim; if it says "socialist feminism," lead with Rowbotham's dual-systems synthesis; the two labels overlap but are not simple synonyms.

Visual-first recall

LATER PROVENANCE AND MARXIST FEMINISM

- |
- [1] Ann Oakley (**Sex, Gender and Society**, 1972) is usually credited with popularising...
- v
- [2] This basic file (like Gauba) uses "socialist feminism" as the umbrella term...
- v
- [3] Exam use: if a question specifically says "Marxist feminism," lead with the domestic-...

Answer-grabbing line: Ann Oakley (*Sex, Gender and Society*, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned,.

Must-write keywords: not; Simone de Beauvoir; Ann Oakley; Gayle Rubin; Claim;; Evidence;; Significance:.

Claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification demonstration

Claim: Ann Oakley (*Sex, Gender and Society*, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology. **Named evidence/example:** This basic file (like Gauba) uses "socialist feminism" as the umbrella term (Rowbotham) for the patriarchy-plus-capitalism synthesis. Marxist feminism is a related but analytically prior strand a strong answer should distinguish. **Analysis:** Read together, these propositions show how later provenance and marxist feminism shapes feminism, sex and gender rather than serving as a detachable list of names. **Qualification:** Exam use: if a question specifically says "Marxist feminism," lead with the domestic-labour/social-reproduction claim; if it says "socialist feminism," lead with Rowbotham's dual-systems synthesis; the two labels overlap but are not simple synonyms.

SESSION 7 - Pateman and Okin: Contract, Justice and the Family

Carole Pateman and Susan Moller Okin: feminist critique of contract and justice theory

- **ANALYSIS:** **Carole Pateman** (*The Sexual Contract*, 1988): **Claim** - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's bodies and labour before the "original" social contract; the public contract of citizens rests on an unmentioned private contract of subordination. **Evidence** - contract narratives are silent on the marriage contract and domestic subordination that make male civic equality possible. **Significance** - reframes liberal equality as resting on an unexamined patriarchal foundation. **Limit** - the thesis reconstructs contract theory's silences; it is an interpretive lens, not a documented historical event, and should not be used as a factual claim about any real contract being signed.
- **ANALYSIS:** **Susan Moller Okin** (*Justice, Gender, and the Family*, 1989): **Claim** - theories of justice (she targets Rawls) wrongly treat the family as a pre-political given rather than a site justice must examine. **Evidence** - unequal domestic burden restricts women's access to the "primary goods" (time, income, position) public justice is meant to

distribute. **Significance** - extends justice from state/market into the household. **Limit** - risks over-extending justice into every private relationship, which is why most syntheses still preserve some sphere of family autonomy alongside gender-just background conditions.

Visual-first recall

PATEMAN AND OKIN: CONTRACT, JUSTICE AND THE FAMILY

- |
- [1] Carole Pateman (*The Sexual Contract*, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract...
- v
- [2] Susan Moller Okin (*Justice, Gender, and the Family*, 1989): Claim - theories of...
- v
- [3] Pateman and Okin: Contract, Justice and the Family must be linked to Feminism, Sex...

Answer-grabbing line: Carole Pateman (*The Sexual Contract*, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's.

Must-write keywords: Carole Pateman; Claim; Evidence; Significance; Limit; Susan Moller Okin; Pateman.

Claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification demonstration

Claim: Carole Pateman (*The Sexual Contract*, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's bodies and labour before the "original" social contract; the public contract of citizens rests on an unmentioned private contract of subordination. Evidence - contract narratives are silent on the marriage contract and domestic subordination that make male civic equality possible. Significance - reframes liberal equality as resting on an unexamined patriarchal foundation. Limit - the thesis reconstructs contract theory's silences; it is an interpretive lens, not a documented historical event, and should not be used as a factual claim about any real contract being signed. **Named evidence/example:** Susan Moller Okin (*Justice, Gender, and the Family*, 1989): Claim - theories of justice (she targets Rawls) wrongly treat the family as a pre-political given rather than a site justice must examine. Evidence - unequal domestic burden restricts women's access to the "primary goods" (time, income, position) public justice is meant to distribute. Significance - extends justice from state/market into the household. Limit - risks over-extending justice into every private relationship, which is why most syntheses still preserve some sphere of family autonomy alongside gender-just background conditions. **Analysis:** Read together, these propositions show how pateman and okin: contract, justice and the family shapes feminism, sex and gender rather than serving as a detachable list of names. **Qualification:** Carole Pateman (*The Sexual Contract*, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's bodies and labour before the "original" social contract; the public contract of citizens rests on an unmentioned private contract of subordination. Evidence - contract narratives are silent on the marriage contract and domestic subordination that make male civic equality possible. Significance - reframes liberal equality as resting on an unexamined patriarchal foundation. Limit - the thesis reconstructs contract theory's silences; it is an interpretive lens, not a documented historical event, and should not be used as a factual claim about any real contract being signed.

SESSION 8 - Butler, Performativity and Intersectionality

Judith Butler and performativity (careful use)

- ANALYSIS: **Judith Butler** (*Gender Trouble*, 1990): gender is not a cultural coating on a stable biological sex but *performative* - produced through repeated, stylised acts (speech, gesture, dress, behaviour) that create the appearance of a natural gendered self; on this account even "sex" is partly constituted through gendered discourse, not a wholly pre-discursive bedrock.
- ANALYSIS: Use with care: (a) do not present this as Gauba's own position - it is a later, more radical move than the textbook sex/gender split; (b) do not claim Butler denies bodies exist - the claim is about how the *meaning and categorisation* of bodies is produced; (c) pair it immediately with the objection/reply below so the answer shows awareness of debate rather than treating performativity as settled.

Intersectionality (Kimberle Crenshaw)

- ANALYSIS: **Kimberle Crenshaw** ("Demarginalizing the Intersection of Race and Sex", 1989): **Claim** - treating race and sex discrimination as separate, additive categories fails women who face a distinct, compounded disadvantage at their intersection. **Evidence** - Crenshaw's illustration showed Black women's employment-discrimination claims falling through the gap between a race-discrimination template and a sex-discrimination template, each implicitly modelled on a different unmarked group. **Significance** - forces liberal/radical/socialist/Marxist feminism to ask *which* women a given claim describes, correcting an unstated universalism. **Limit** - an intersectional list can become analytically unwieldy without a clear political question in view; it supplements, but should not replace, the structural claims of the four schools above.

Visual-first recall

BUTLER, PERFORMATIVITY AND INTERSECTIONALITY

- |
- [1] Judith Butler (*Gender Trouble*, 1990): gender is not a cultural coating on a stable...
- v
- [2] Use with care: (a) do not present this as Gauba's own position - it is a later, more...
- v
- [3] Kimberle Crenshaw ("Demarginalizing the Intersection of Race and Sex", 1989): Claim - ...

Answer-grabbing line: Judith Butler (*Gender Trouble*, 1990): gender is not a cultural coating on a stable biological sex but *performative* - produced through repeated, stylised acts (speech, gesture, dress,...

Must-write keywords: Judith Butler; Kimberle Crenshaw; Claim; Evidence; Significance; Limit; Butler.

Claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification demonstration

Claim: Judith Butler (*Gender Trouble*, 1990): gender is not a cultural coating on a stable biological sex but *performative* - produced through repeated, stylised acts (speech, gesture, dress, behaviour) that create the appearance of a natural gendered self; on this account even "sex" is partly constituted through gendered discourse, not a wholly pre-discursive bedrock. **Named evidence/example:** Use with care: (a) do not present this as Gauba's own position - it is a later, more radical move than the textbook sex/gender split; (b) do not claim Butler denies bodies exist - the claim is about how the *meaning and categorisation* of bodies is produced; (c) pair it immediately with the objection/reply below so the answer shows awareness of debate rather than treating performativity as settled.

Analysis: Read together, these propositions show how butler, performativity and intersectionality shapes feminism, sex and gender rather than serving as a detachable list of names. **Qualification:** Judith Butler (*Gender Trouble*, 1990): gender is not a cultural coating on a stable biological sex but *performative* - produced through repeated, stylised acts (speech, gesture, dress, behaviour) that create the appearance of a natural gendered self; on this account even "sex" is partly constituted through gendered discourse, not a wholly pre-discursive bedrock.

SESSION 9 - Objection-Reply Chains and Cautious Indian Application

14. Two objection-reply chains (mandatory doctrinal debate)

1. **Objection:** if gender is entirely performative/socially constructed (Butler), feminism loses a stable category of "woman" around which to organise and to claim rights.

Reply: many feminist theorists respond that political claims can be built on provisionally, strategically stabilised categories even while accepting the category is historically constructed ("strategic essentialism"); legal sex-discrimination categories function pragmatically regardless of deeper philosophical instability. ANALYSIS: Present as a live, contested debate - not a settled result.

2. **Objection:** radical feminism's emphasis on patriarchy as the primary, near-universal structure of oppression risks treating "women" as one undifferentiated class, erasing differences of race, class and caste among women.

Reply: Crenshaw's intersectionality and Marxist/socialist feminism's attention to class supply the corrective - oppression is compounded and differently configured across axes, producing a more accurate map of *whose* subordination is being explained. ANALYSIS: This reply strengthens rather than replaces the original radical-feminist insight that sexual/reproductive domination is analytically distinct from class or race domination.

15. Cautious Indian application

- ANALYSIS: **Savitribai Phule** is widely associated, with Jyotirao Phule, with pioneering girls' education in nineteenth-century Maharashtra - use as an illustration of an early, home-grown challenge to gendered exclusion from education; do not attach specific unverified school-opening dates or numbers unless independently confirmed. Keep the claim at "early advocate of women's education against caste-and-gender exclusion."
- ANALYSIS: **B. R. Ambedkar** is widely associated with linking women's legal and social equality to the wider project of social democracy, including reform of Hindu personal law - treat this as a general, well-known orientation of his thought rather than citing precise bill provisions, sections or dates, since exact legislative detail sits outside this file's verified source base.
- ANALYSIS: The broader Indian women's movement (legal-reform and political-representation campaigns from the 1970s onward) is a standard illustrative anchor for "formal legal equality is not the end of the feminist question" - use it as a *type* of example (movement-led legal reform), not with specific statute names, years or case citations unless separately verified through a dedicated Polity/legal source.
- ANALYSIS: Discipline: this file owns the *conceptual* application (patriarchy, sex/gender, representation gap); it does not own specific constitutional articles, acts or case law - route those to the Polity module (as already flagged in section 10) rather than asserting legal facts here.

Visual-first recall

OBJECTION-REPLY CHAINS AND CAUTIOUS INDIAN APPLICATION

```
|
[1] 1. Objection: if gender is entirely performative/socially constructed (Butler),...
v
[2] Reply: many feminist theorists respond that political claims can be built on...
v
[3] 2. Objection: radical feminism's emphasis on patriarchy as the primary, near-...
v
[4] Reply: Crenshaw's intersectionality and Marxist/socialist feminism's attention to...
```

Answer-grabbing line: 1. Objection: if gender is entirely performative/socially constructed (Butler), feminism loses a stable category of "woman" around which to organise and to claim rights.

Must-write keywords: Objection;; Reply;; Savitribai Phule; B. R. Ambedkar; Objection-Reply Chains; Cautious Indian; Application.

Claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification demonstration

Claim: 1. Objection: if gender is entirely performative/socially constructed (Butler), feminism loses a stable category of "woman" around which to organise and to claim rights. **Named evidence/example:** Reply: many feminist theorists respond that political claims can be built on provisionally, strategically stabilised categories even while accepting the category is historically constructed ("strategic essentialism"); legal sex-discrimination categories function pragmatically regardless of deeper philosophical instability. Present as a live, contested debate - not a settled result. **Analysis:** Read together, these propositions show how objection-reply chains and cautious indian application shapes feminism, sex and gender rather than serving as a detachable list of names. **Qualification:** Reply: many feminist theorists respond that political claims can be built on provisionally, strategically stabilised categories even while accepting the category is historically constructed ("strategic essentialism"); legal sex-discrimination categories function pragmatically regardless of deeper philosophical instability. Present as a live, contested debate - not a settled result.

SESSION 10 - Directive Decoding and Mark-Scaled Answer Architecture

16. Executable answer architecture (10/15 marks)

Directive decoding

- "Discuss/Examine feminism as a critique of patriarchy" -> needs both diagnosis (what patriarchy is, how gender is produced) and the feminist reply; do not describe patriarchy without the feminist response.
- "Distinguish sex and gender" -> definitional/analytical directive: give the distinction plus why it matters, not two one-line definitions.

- "Critically examine feminist perspectives on X" -> requires thesis + at least two schools compared + at least one objection/reply, ending in a reasoned verdict, not a neutral list.

10-mark architecture (~150 words)

1. **Thesis (1-2 lines):** feminism protests patriarchal subordination via the sex/gender distinction; formal legal equality alone is insufficient.
2. **Body:** sex vs gender (claim->evidence->significance) + one stream (liberal/radical/socialist/Marxist) with its core mechanism.
3. **One qualifier/limit.**
4. **One-line conclusion** tied to the thesis.

15-mark architecture (~200-250 words)

1. Thesis with directive-specific framing.
2. Doctrine reconstruction: sex/gender distinction (de Beauvoir/Oakley/Rubin, ANALYSIS:-flagged) -> patriarchy as a political, not merely domestic, category.
3. Compare 2-3 streams (liberal/radical/socialist-Marxist) using claim->evidence->significance->limit each.
4. One objection-reply chain.
5. One cautious Indian illustration.
6. Reasoned conclusion.
1. Thesis + explicit directive decoding.
2. Full doctrine reconstruction: patriarchy -> sex/gender (de Beauvoir/Oakley/Rubin) -> why biology does not justify hierarchy (Rousseau's natural/conventional inequality, per Gauba).
3. All streams (liberal, radical, socialist, Marxist) each with claim->evidence->significance->limit.
4. Pateman/Okin extension where the question concerns citizenship, justice or the family.
5. Two objection-reply chains (performativity vs category stability; single-axis vs intersectionality).
6. Cautious Indian application, correctly hedged, without owning legal specifics.
7. Balanced, graded conclusion noting both formal-equality achievement and the unfinished substantive-equality agenda.

Quotation/proposition method

- Prefer paraphrased, named propositions over unverified verbatim quotations, e.g. *"de Beauvoir's proposition that womanhood is socially produced rather than born"* rather than a quoted sentence, unless the quotation is independently confirmed. This credits the correct thinker and claim while avoiding misquotation risk.

Visual-first recall

DIRECTIVE DECODING AND MARK-SCALED ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

- |
- [1] "Discuss/Examine feminism as a critique of patriarchy" -> needs both diagnosis (what...
 - v
- [2] "Distinguish sex and gender" -> definitional/analytical directive: give the...
 - v
- [3] "Critically examine feminist perspectives on X" -> requires thesis + at least two...
 - v
- [4] 1. Thesis (1-2 lines): feminism protests patriarchal subordination via the sex/gender...

Answer-grabbing line: "Discuss/Examine feminism as a critique of patriarchy" -> needs both diagnosis (what patriarchy is, how gender is produced) and the feminist reply; do not describe patriarchy without the.

Must-write keywords: Thesis (1-2 lines);; Body;; One qualifier/limit.; One-line conclusion; Directive Decoding; Mark-Scaled Answer; Architecture.

Claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification demonstration

Claim: "Discuss/Examine feminism as a critique of patriarchy" -> needs both diagnosis (what patriarchy is, how gender is produced) and the feminist reply; do not describe patriarchy without the feminist response. **Named evidence/example:** "Distinguish sex and gender" -> definitional/analytical directive: give the distinction plus why it matters, not two one-line definitions. **Analysis:** Read together, these propositions show how directive decoding and mark-scaled answer architecture shapes feminism, sex and gender rather than serving as a detachable list of names. **Qualification:** "Discuss/Examine feminism as a critique of patriarchy" -> needs both diagnosis (what patriarchy is, how gender is produced) and the feminist reply; do not describe patriarchy without the feminist response.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

The following text-native master is identical to the standalone ASCII artifact.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/13: GS/Prelims Boundary

+-----+ GS/PRELIMS BOUNDARY +-----+	
01. TARGET: UPSC Prelims + General Studies Mains only.	
	v
02. PRIMARY USE: GS-II conceptual foundations.	
	v
03. TOPIC SCOPE: Feminism, Sex and Gender.	
	v
04. Read the deeper companion at Political-Theory/advanced/06_Feminism-Sex-and-Gender.md	
	v
05. ADVANCED label = enrichment beyond a core GS answer, not an exam-paper label.	
+-----+	

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/13: Origin and Dated Rail (1/2)

+-----+ ORIGIN AND DATED RAIL (1/2) +-----+	
01. 1755 -> A Discourse on the Origin of Inequality	
	v
02. 1759-97 -> Mary Wollstonecraft	
	v
03. 1759-97 -> Theory When Mary Wollstonecraft	
	v
04. 1792 -> Vindication of the Rights of Woman	
	v
05. 1806-73 -> John Stuart Mill	
	v
06. 1807-59 -> Harriet Taylor	
+-----+	

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/13: Origin and Dated Rail (2/2)

+-----+ ORIGIN AND DATED RAIL (2/2) +-----+	
07. 1869 -> The Subjection of Women	
	v
08. 1970 -> The Dialectic of Sex	
	v
09. 1971 -> Sexual Politics	
	v
10. 1972 -> Women, Resistance and Revolution	
	v
11. 1973 -> Hidden from History	
	v
12. 1989 -> She continued this approach in The Past is before Us	
+-----+	

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/13: Chapter Spine

CHAPTER SPINE

| 01. Gauba starts by defining feminism as resistance to unjust female subordination produced by patriarchy. (PDF p.84)

| v

| 02. He then distinguishes sex from gender so that biological difference is separated from socially assigned inferiority. (PDF pp.84-86)

| v

| 03. Gender roles such as aggressiveness/dominance for men and submissiveness/expressiveness for women are treated as cultural instruments of social control. (PDF p.85)

| v

| 04. Gauba argues that biological differences do not justify inferior status for women; the main causes lie in social arrangements and cultural conditioning. (PDF pp.86-87)

| v

05. He ends by classifying feminism into liberal, radical and socialist streams. (PDF pp.88-90)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/13: Illustrations Attached to Claims

ILLUSTRATIONS ATTACHED TO CLAIMS

| 01. Gauba's examples of girls being socialized toward obedience and boys toward assertiveness show how gender roles are culturally produced. (PDF p.87)

| 02. The early rights agenda focused on education, property, divorce and suffrage because these exclusions had no necessary connection with female biology. (PDF pp.87-88)

| 03. A safe classroom example is to contrast biological maternity with culturally assigned ideas that women must therefore remain outside public life

04. Gauba's cited 1980 UN numerical claim and the follow-up line saying the condition remained unchanged should never be repeated as current fact; at most they are dated book-period illustrations. (PDF p.86)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/13: Comparison Matrix

COMPARISON MATRIX

| 01. LIBERAL FEMINISM | Core claim = Women deserve equal opportunity and equal rights in all walks of life. (PDF p.88) | Main obstacle identified = Formal legal, educational and professional barriers. (PDF pp.88-89) | Remedy emphasized = Equal pay, representation, reform of discriminatory laws. (PDF p.88)

| 02. RADICAL FEMINISM | Core claim = Women's oppression is primary and cannot be reduced to some deeper system alone. (PDF p.89) | Main obstacle identified = Patriarchal sexual power and reproductive dependence. (PDF p.89) | Remedy emphasized = Transform sex-power relations and dismantle domination. (PDF p.89)

| 03. SOCIALIST FEMINISM | Core claim = Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism. (PDF pp.89-90) | Main obstacle identified = Wage labour, domestic labour and class exploitation together. (PDF pp.89-90) | Remedy emphasized = Link women's liberation with broader anti-capitalist and anti-oppression struggles. (PDF p.90)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/13: Examiner Trap Firewall

EXAMINER TRAP FIREWALL

| 01. TRAP: Sex and gender mean the same thing => REPAIR: Gauba makes the distinction foundational: sex is biological, gender is cultural. (PDF pp.84-86)

| 02. TRAP: All feminism says women are biologically determined => REPAIR: Firestone's reproductive-biology argument is one radical-feminist position, not feminism's consensus. (PDF p.89)

03. TRAP: If women receive equal legal rights, feminism has no further issue => REPAIR: Gauba shows later feminism asking about representation, social status and unequal participation in public power. (PDF pp.91-93)

| 04. TRAP: Old statistics in the book can be quoted as present reality => REPAIR: The 1980 UN figure and book-era representation data are historical and must not be presented as current fact. (PDF pp.86, 91-93)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/13: Ownership Boundaries and Cross-Links

| OWNERSHIP BOUNDARIES AND CROSS-LINKS

| 01. Read the deeper companion at Political-Theory/advanced/06_Feminism-Sex-and-Gender.md
 | 02. Use Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md for the ideology matrix and anti-caricature guidance on feminism
 | 03. Use Political-Theory/README.md for the module map linking feminism to state, power, citizenship and justice
 | 04. For cross-syllabus support, use Philosophy/paper-2/socio-political/Gender-Discrimination.md
 | 05. For constitutional-equality application, move outward to Polity/advanced/07_Fundamental-Rights.md
 | 06. Topic-map continuities especially matter with Political-Theory/basic/13_Diverse-Perspectives-on-the-State.md (feminist state), Political-Theory/basic/15_Power-Authority-and-Legitimacy.md (gendered power), Political-Theory/basic/16_Citizenship-and-Its-Critiques.md (feminist citizenship) and Political-Theory/basic/20_Diverse-Perspectives-on-Justice.md (feminist justice)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/13: Revision Capsule

| REVISION CAPSULE

| 01. Begin with feminism as protest against patriarchy. (PDF p.84)

v

| 02. Define sex and gender separately and sharply. (PDF pp.84-86)

v

| 03. Use Rousseau's natural/conventional inequality distinction to show why gender hierarchy is alterable. (PDF p.86)

v

| 04. Note that biological differences do not justify inferior status. (PDF pp.86-87)

v

| 05. Classify feminism into liberal, radical and socialist streams with one thinker each. (PDF pp.88-90)

v

| 06. End by warning against using Gauba's dated numerical claims as present-day evidence. (PDF pp.86, 91-93)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/13: Answer-Grabbing Line Bank

| ANSWER-GRABBING LINE BANK

| 01. Gauba treats feminism as a protest against the inferior status assigned to women by patriarchy, not as a denial that biological differences exist. (PDF pp.84-86)
 | 02. Feminism: concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex. (PDF p.84)
 | 03. Sex vs gender: sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social. (PDF pp.84-86)
 | 04. Gauba's examples of girls being socialized toward obedience and boys toward assertiveness show how gender roles are culturally produced. (PDF p.87)
 | 05. Read the deeper companion at Political-Theory/advanced/06_Feminism-Sex-and-Gender.md
 | 06. Ann Oakley (Sex, Gender and Society, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned
 | 07. Carole Pateman (The Sexual Contract, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's
 | 08. Judith Butler (Gender Trouble, 1990): gender is not a cultural coating on a stable biological sex but performative - produced through repeated, stylised acts (speech, gesture,

| dress
 | 09. 1. Objection: if gender is entirely performative/socially constructed (Butler), feminism
 | loses a stable category of "woman" around which to organise and to claim rights
 | 10. "Discuss/Examine feminism as a critique of patriarchy" -> needs both diagnosis (what
 | patriarchy is, how gender is produced) and the feminist reply; do not describe patriarchy
 | without the
 +-----+

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/13: Must-Write Keyword Bank

+-----+
 | MUST-WRITE KEYWORD BANK
 +-----+
 | 01. Subject;; Tier;; Exam relevance;; Core area;; Grounded in;; Source edition/cutoff;;
 | Patriarchy
 | 02. Feminism;; Patriarchy;; Sex;; Gender;; Gender inequality;; Feminist theory;; Gender
 | 03. Sex vs gender;; Natural inequality vs conventional inequality;; Legal equality vs
 | substantive equality;; Equal treatment vs compensatory support;; Biology justifies
 | hierarchy;; Mary Wollstonecraft;; J.S. Mill:
 | 04. Sex and gender mean the same thing;; All feminism says women are biologically
 | determined;; If women receive equal legal rights, feminism has no further issue;; Old
 | statistics in the book can be quoted as present reality;; Illustrations; Comparative Matrix;
 | Trap Repair
 | 05. Ownership Boundaries; Revision Spine; Source Discipline; SESSION; Cross-links; Read;
 | Political-Theory
 | 06. not; Simone de Beauvoir; Ann Oakley; Gayle Rubin; Claim;; Evidence;; Significance:
 | 07. Carole Pateman; Claim; Evidence; Significance; Limit; Susan Moller Okin; Pateman
 | 08. Judith Butler; Kimberle Crenshaw; Claim; Evidence; Significance; Limit; Butler
 | 09. Objection;; Reply;; Savitribai Phule; B. R. Ambedkar; Objection-Reply Chains; Cautious
 | Indian; Application
 | 10. Thesis (1-2 lines);; Body;; One qualifier/limit;; One-line conclusion; Directive
 | Decoding; Mark-Scaled Answer; Architecture
 +-----+

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/13: GS Mains Question Routes

+-----+
 | GS MAINS QUESTION ROUTES
 +-----+
 | 01. 10 MARKS: Distinguish sex from gender and explain why the distinction matters
 | politically. Answer in 150 words
 | 02. 10 MARKS: Why is patriarchy a political category rather than merely a description of
 | family authority? Answer in 150 words
 | 03. 10 MARKS: Compare liberal, radical, Marxist and socialist feminism as explanations of
 | women's subordination. Answer in 150 words
 | 04. 15 MARKS: Critically examine Judith Butler's account of gender performativity and the
 | category problem it creates for feminism. Answer in 250 words
 | 05. 15 MARKS: Evaluate the feminist critique of the public-private divide with reference to
 | Carole Pateman and Susan Moller Okin. Answer in 250 words
 | 06. 15 MARKS: Is feminism best understood as a project of equality, empowerment or social
 | transformation? Discuss. Answer in 250 words
 +-----+

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 13/13: Qualified Verdict and Answer Spine

+-----+
 | QUALIFIED VERDICT AND ANSWER SPINE
 +-----+
 | 01. Open with the boundary line, not with a general definition.
 |
 | v
 | 02. Carry the argument on named evidence taken from the thinker panels.
 |
 | v
 | 03. Insert the trap-firewall distinction that the question is testing.
 |
 | v
 | 04. Add the objection or limitation before concluding.
 |
 | v
 | 05. CLOSE: Carole Pateman (The Sexual Contract, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract
 | theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's
 | access to women's. Ann Oakley (Sex, Gender and Society, 1972) is usually credited with
 | popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as
 +-----+

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice design

- Questions 1-24 are hard core GS/Prelims diagnostics; Questions 25-32 are remedial close-option repairs.
- Formats are deliberately varied: definition control, multi-statement, sequence, matching, chronology, elimination, application, evidence and inference.
- The correct option rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D, repeated eight times across the 32 questions, giving 8 A, 8 B, 8 C and 8 D.
- Because the key is a fixed rotation it carries no diagnostic value: options are matched for register and length, so an answer can only be reached by reasoning about content.
- Each of the 128 options carries its own question-specific explanation and each question closes with a distinct examiner trap.

MCQ 1

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Feminism**?

- A. concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.
- B. early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power.
- C. argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.
- D. radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological change.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Feminism.
- **B:** B Attaches to Legal equality vs substantive equality, not Feminism.
- **C:** C Attaches to Mary Wollstonecraft, not Feminism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Shulamith Firestone, not Feminism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Feminism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 2

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Patriarchy**?

- A. radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology.
- B. literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.
- C. argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.
- D. Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Kate Millett, not Patriarchy.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Patriarchy.

- **C:** C Attaches to Mary Wollstonecraft, not Patriarchy.
- **D:** D Attaches to Natural inequality vs conventional inequality, not Patriarchy.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Patriarchy by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 3

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Sex**?

- A. argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights.
- B. Women's oppression is primary and cannot be reduced to some deeper system alone.
- C. biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.
- D. a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to J.S. Mill, not Sex.
- **B:** B Attaches to Radical feminism, not Sex.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Sex.
- **D:** D Attaches to Gender inequality, not Sex.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Sex by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 4

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Gender**?

- A. seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation.
- B. argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights.
- C. advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.
- D. culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Liberal feminism, not Gender.
- **B:** B Attaches to J.S. Mill, not Gender.
- **C:** C Attaches to Feminist theory, not Gender.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Gender.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Gender by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 5

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Gender inequality**?

- A. a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change.
- B. Women deserve equal opportunity and equal rights in all walks of life.
- C. Women's oppression is primary and cannot be reduced to some deeper system alone.
- D. biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Gender inequality.

- **B:** B Attaches to Liberal feminism, not Gender inequality.
- **C:** C Attaches to Radical feminism, not Gender inequality.
- **D:** D Attaches to Sex, not Gender inequality.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Gender inequality by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 6

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Feminist theory**?

- A. seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation.
- B. advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.
- C. radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology.
- D. socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Liberal feminism, not Feminist theory.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Feminist theory.
- **C:** C Attaches to Kate Millett, not Feminist theory.
- **D:** D Attaches to Sheila Rowbotham, not Feminist theory.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Feminist theory by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 7

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Sex vs gender**?

- A. Women deserve equal opportunity and equal rights in all walks of life.
- B. Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism.
- C. sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.
- D. a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Liberal feminism, not Sex vs gender.
- **B:** B Attaches to Socialist feminism, not Sex vs gender.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Sex vs gender.
- **D:** D Attaches to Gender inequality, not Sex vs gender.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Sex vs gender by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 8

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Natural inequality vs conventional inequality**?

- A. radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology.
- B. literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.
- C. socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions.
- D. Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Kate Millett, not Natural inequality vs conventional inequality.
- **B:** B Attaches to Patriarchy, not Natural inequality vs conventional inequality.
- **C:** C Attaches to Sheila Rowbotham, not Natural inequality vs conventional inequality.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Natural inequality vs conventional inequality.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Natural inequality vs conventional inequality by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 9

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Legal equality vs substantive equality - early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone.
- B. Feminism - argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.
- C. Shulamith Firestone - literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.
- D. Equal treatment vs compensatory support - Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Records the association: Legal equality vs substantive equality is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: Feminism is recorded with concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Shulamith Firestone is recorded with radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological change.
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: Equal treatment vs compensatory support is recorded with Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Legal equality vs substantive equality; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 10

Which of the following pairs a name or concept with the proposition the source actually records for it?

- A. Legal equality vs substantive equality - argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.
- B. Equal treatment vs compensatory support - Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related.
- C. Shulamith Firestone - (Justice, Gender, and the Family, 1989): Claim - theories of justice (she targets Rawls) wrongly treat the family as a pre-political.
- D. Feminism - literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life; the other dimensions would remain secondary under this reading.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: Legal equality vs substantive equality is recorded with early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power.
- **B:** B Matches the record: Equal treatment vs compensatory support is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Shulamith Firestone is recorded with radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological change.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Feminism is recorded with concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Equal treatment vs compensatory support; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 11

In which pair does the proposition genuinely belong to the label placed against it?

- A. Kate Millett - advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.
- B. Patriarchy - socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions.
- C. Mary Wollstonecraft - argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.
- D. Natural inequality vs conventional inequality - concern with the status and role of women in relation to men.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Misplaced: Kate Millett is recorded with radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: Patriarchy is recorded with literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.
- **C:** C Exact pair: Mary Wollstonecraft is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Natural inequality vs conventional inequality is recorded with Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Mary Wollstonecraft; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 12

Only one pairing below reproduces the source's own association. Which is it?

- A. Liberal feminism - radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology.
- B. Gender - advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.
- C. Sex - Women's oppression is primary and cannot be reduced to some deeper system alone.
- D. J.S. Mill - argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Liberal feminism is recorded with seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation.
- **B:** B Cross-attached: Gender is recorded with culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.
- **C:** C Mismatched: Sex is recorded with biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.
- **D:** D Matches the record: J.S. Mill is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to J.S. Mill; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 13

Identify the pair in which the recorded proposition matches its label exactly.

- A. Liberal feminism - seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation.
- B. Gender - radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology.
- C. Feminist theory - socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions.
- D. J.S. Mill - Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source-exact: Liberal feminism is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Mismatched: Gender is recorded with culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.
- **C:** C Not this pair: Feminist theory is recorded with advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: J.S. Mill is recorded with argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Liberal feminism; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 14

Which one of the following label-proposition pairings survives a strict source check?

- A. Equal treatment vs compensatory support - argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.
- B. Shulamith Firestone - radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological.
- C. Legal equality vs substantive equality - literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.
- D. Feminism - Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category; the rival mechanism is treated as non-decisive in this account.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Equal treatment vs compensatory support is recorded with Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.
- **B:** B Exact pair: Shulamith Firestone is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Wrong attachment: Legal equality vs substantive equality is recorded with early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power.
- **D:** D Source disagrees: Feminism is recorded with concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Shulamith Firestone; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 15

Which pairing below would a careful source check leave standing?

- A. Feminist theory - culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.
- B. Sheila Rowbotham - seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation.
- C. Kate Millett - radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology.
- D. Natural inequality vs conventional inequality - literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Feminist theory is recorded with advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: Sheila Rowbotham is recorded with socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions.
- **C:** C Records the association: Kate Millett is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Misplaced: Natural inequality vs conventional inequality is recorded with Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Kate Millett; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 16

Which of these attributions is reproduced correctly rather than shifted to a neighbouring idea?

- A. Natural inequality vs conventional inequality - literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household.
- B. Kate Millett - seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation.
- C. Feminist theory - culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.
- D. Sheila Rowbotham - socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: Natural inequality vs conventional inequality is recorded with Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category.
- **B:** B Source disagrees: Kate Millett is recorded with radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Feminist theory is recorded with advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.
- **D:** D Matches the record: Sheila Rowbotham is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Sheila Rowbotham; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 17

Consider the following statements:

1. **Liberal feminism** is associated with: Women deserve equal opportunity and equal rights in all walks of life.
2. **Simone de Beauvoir** is associated with: (Justice, Gender, and the Family, 1989): Claim - theories of justice (she targets Rawls) wrongly treat the family as a pre-political given rather than a site justice must examine.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Liberal feminism does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 18

Consider the following statements:

1. **Radical feminism** is associated with: (Sex, Gender and Society, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology.
2. **Ann Oakley** is associated with: (Sex, Gender and Society, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Radical feminism does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 19

Consider the following statements:

1. **Socialist feminism** is associated with: Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism.
2. **Gayle Rubin** is associated with: ("The Traffic in Women", 1975) supplies the mechanism often paired with the distinction: the "sex/gender system" - social arrangements that transform biological sex into a hierarchy of gendered obligation, kinship exchange and constrained sexuality. Rubin explains how sex becomes gender, which Gauba's chapter asserts but does not mechanise.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Socialist feminism does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 20

Consider the following statements:

1. **Simone de Beauvoir** is associated with: (The Sexual Contract, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's bodies and labour before the "original" social contract; the public contract of citizens rests on an unmentioned private contract of subordination.
2. **Carole Pateman** is associated with: biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Simone de Beauvoir does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 21

Consider the following statements:

1. **Ann Oakley** is associated with: (Sex, Gender and Society, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology.
2. **Susan Moller Okin** is associated with: culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Ann Oakley does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 22

Consider the following statements:

1. **Gayle Rubin** is associated with: concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.
2. **Feminism** is associated with: concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Gayle Rubin does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 23

Consider the following statements:

1. **Carole Pateman** is associated with: (The Sexual Contract, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's bodies and labour before the "original" social contract; the public contract of citizens rests on an unmentioned private contract of subordination.
2. **Patriarchy** is associated with: literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Carole Pateman does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 24

Consider the following statements:

1. **Susan Moller Okin** is associated with: biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.
2. **Sex** is associated with: sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Susan Moller Okin does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Sex and gender mean the same thing.**?

- A. Gauba makes the distinction foundational: sex is biological, gender is cultural. (PDF pp.84-86)
- B. Sex means biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.
- C. Gender inequality means a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change.
- D. Gender means culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba makes the distinction foundational: sex is biological, gender is cultural. (PDF pp.84-86).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Sex means Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Gender inequality means Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Gender means early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Sex and gender mean the same thing, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **All feminism says women are biologically determined.**?

- A. Gender means culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.
- B. Firestone's reproductive-biology argument is one radical-feminist position, not feminism's consensus. (PDF p.89)
- C. Patriarchy means literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.
- D. Gender inequality means a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Gender means early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Firestone's reproductive-biology argument is one radical-feminist position, not feminism's consensus. (PDF p.89).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Patriarchy means sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Gender inequality means Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about All feminism says women are biologically determined, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **If women receive equal legal rights, feminism has no further issue.**?

- A. Feminism means concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.
- B. Patriarchy means literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.
- C. Gauba shows later feminism asking about representation, social status and unequal participation in public power. (PDF pp.91-93)
- D. Firestone's reproductive-biology argument is one radical-feminist position, not feminism's consensus. (PDF p.89)

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Feminism means advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Patriarchy means sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba shows later feminism asking about representation, social status and unequal participation in public power. (PDF pp.91-93).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'All feminism says women are biologically determined.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about If women receive equal legal rights, feminism has no, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Feminism means advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.?**

- A. Patriarchy means literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.
- B. Gauba shows later feminism asking about representation, social status and unequal participation in public power. (PDF pp.91-93)
- C. Firestone's reproductive-biology argument is one radical-feminist position, not feminism's consensus. (PDF p.89)
- D. Feminism means concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Patriarchy means sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'If women receive equal legal rights, feminism has no further issue.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'All feminism says women are biologically determined.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Feminism means concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Feminism means advocacy of equal rights for women, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Patriarchy means sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.?**

- A. Patriarchy means literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.
- B. Gauba shows later feminism asking about representation, social status and unequal participation in public power. (PDF pp.91-93)
- C. Firestone's reproductive-biology argument is one radical-feminist position, not feminism's consensus. (PDF p.89)
- D. Feminism means concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Patriarchy means literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'If women receive equal legal rights, feminism has no further issue.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'All feminism says women are biologically determined.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Feminism means advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Patriarchy means sex is natural/biological; gender, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Sex means Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category.?**

- A. Gauba makes the distinction foundational: sex is biological, gender is cultural. (PDF pp.84-86)
- B. Sex means biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.
- C. Gender inequality means a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change.
- D. Gender means culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Sex and gender mean the same thing.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Sex means biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Gender inequality means Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Gender means early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Sex means Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Gender means early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power.?**

- A. Gauba makes the distinction foundational: sex is biological, gender is cultural. (PDF pp.84-86)
- B. Firestone's reproductive-biology argument is one radical-feminist position, not feminism's consensus. (PDF p.89)
- C. Gender means culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.
- D. Gender inequality means a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Sex and gender mean the same thing.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'All feminism says women are biologically determined.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gender means culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Gender inequality means Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Gender means early feminism attacked barriers to, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Gender inequality means Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.?**

- A. Gender means culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.
- B. Gauba makes the distinction foundational: sex is biological, gender is cultural. (PDF pp.84-86)
- C. Sex means biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.
- D. Gender inequality means a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Gender means early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Sex and gender mean the same thing.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Sex means Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gender inequality means a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Gender inequality means Gauba notes two broad views., not a different error from the same topic.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS

No direct owned UPSC Prelims or General Studies Mains PYQ is verified for **Feminism, Sex and Gender** in the repository's routed ledgers. Political Theory is a GS/Prelims conceptual-support subject, and proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ ownership is prohibited. Questions owned by another UPSC paper are not imported. The six questions below are clearly labelled original GS Mains practice.

ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish sex from gender and explain why the distinction matters politically. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive distinguish requires the answer to fix each side of the distinction precisely and show where it does the analytical work. Fix the boundary of sex from gender and explain why the distinction matters politically in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Sex, Core and Rousseau's, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: The distinction is politically decisive because bodily difference does not entail social rank: once gender hierarchy is recognised as historically produced, it becomes open to criticism, collective action and institutional transformation.

Model answer (126 words):

Introduction: Sex ordinarily refers to bodily and reproductive characteristics, whereas gender refers to the socially organised roles, expectations and status attached to perceived sex. Core analysis: The distinction explains how a biological difference becomes a political hierarchy. Gauba treats masculinity and femininity as culturally coded

patterns rather than necessary consequences of anatomy. Rousseau's natural-conventional distinction then clarifies the normative point: even where bodily differences are real, unequal education, work, authority and citizenship are conventional arrangements. Feminism can therefore challenge the inference from difference to inferiority. This complication revises the framework without restoring biological destiny. Conclusion: The distinction is politically decisive because bodily difference does not entail social rank: once gender hierarchy is recognised as historically produced, it becomes open to criticism, collective action and institutional transformation.

Why this earns marks: it obeys distinguish instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Sex, Core and Rousseau's), converts that evidence into analysis of sex from gender and explain why the distinction matters politically, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: The distinction is politically decisive because bodily difference does not entail social rank: once gender hierarchy is recognised as historically produced, it becomes open to criticism, collective action and institutional transformation. At 126 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks

Question: Why is patriarchy a political category rather than merely a description of family authority? Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive why requires the answer to give the grounds, not only the description, and rank them. Fix the boundary of is patriarchy a political category rather than merely a description of family authority in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Patriarchy, Core and Gendered, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that introduction: Patriarchy literally evokes rule of the father, but feminist theory uses it for a wider structure of male domination extending beyond the household.

Model answer (134 words):

Introduction: Patriarchy literally evokes rule of the father, but feminist theory uses it for a wider structure of male domination extending beyond the household. Core analysis: It is political because it distributes power and life chances. Gendered socialisation shapes aspirations; the division of paid and unpaid labour shapes economic dependence; control over sexuality and reproduction shapes bodily autonomy; and unequal representation shapes public decision-making. Kate Millett therefore interprets relations between the sexes as power relations supported by ideology and authority. It is strongest when tied to identifiable mechanisms of unequal power rather than used as a slogan for every disadvantage. Conclusion: Patriarchy is political because it organises power, labour, status and voice across household and public institutions; feminist theory therefore makes domination within the so-called private sphere answerable to standards of freedom and justice.

Why this earns marks: it obeys why instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Patriarchy, Core and Gendered), converts that evidence into analysis of is patriarchy a political category rather than merely a description of family authority, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that introduction: Patriarchy literally evokes rule of the father, but feminist theory uses it for a wider structure of male domination extending beyond the household. At 134 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks

Question: Compare liberal, radical, Marxist and socialist feminism as explanations of women's subordination. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive compare requires the answer to run the comparison on shared axes and end with the decisive difference. Fix the boundary of liberal, radical, Marxist and socialist feminism as explanations of women's subordination in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Feminist, Core and Liberal, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: The four approaches are best treated as complementary but contestable lenses: rights, sexual power, capitalist reproduction and interacting systems each reveal a distinct mechanism that no single-axis explanation exhausts.

Model answer (148 words):

Introduction: Feminist schools share opposition to unjust gender hierarchy but disagree over its principal mechanism and the institutional depth of the remedy. Core analysis: Liberal feminism locates the problem in discriminatory laws, blocked education, unequal opportunity and weak representation; Wollstonecraft and Mill support rights-based reform.

Radical feminism treats patriarchal control of sexuality, reproduction and cultural meaning as a primary system not reducible to class; Millett and Firestone illustrate different versions. Marxist feminism explains how capitalism benefits from women's paid and unpaid reproductive labour. Socialist feminism, associated here with Rowbotham, rejects class reduction and analyses capitalism and patriarchy as distinct but mutually reinforcing structures. Further development: The remedies follow from the diagnoses. Comparison should identify what each explains best. Conclusion: The four approaches are best treated as complementary but contestable lenses: rights, sexual power, capitalist reproduction and interacting systems each reveal a distinct mechanism that no single-axis explanation exhausts.

Why this earns marks: it obeys compare instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Feminist, Core and Liberal), converts that evidence into analysis of liberal, radical, Marxist and socialist feminism as explanations of women's subordination, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: The four approaches are best treated as complementary but contestable lenses: rights, sexual power, capitalist reproduction and interacting systems each reveal a distinct mechanism that no single-axis explanation exhausts. At 148 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks

Question: Critically examine Judith Butler's account of gender performativity and the category problem it creates for feminism. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive critically examine requires the answer to test the proposition against its strongest objection before giving a verdict. Fix the boundary of examine Judith Butler's account of gender performativity and the category problem it creates for feminism in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Judith Butler, Core and Performativity, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Butler strengthens feminism by exposing the repeated practices that naturalise gender, but political action still requires provisional categories whose strategic use must remain open to internal criticism and revision.

Model answer (247 words):

Introduction: Judith Butler radicalises the sex-gender debate by treating gender as performative: repeated, socially compelled acts produce the appearance of a natural identity. Core analysis: Performativity does not mean a freely chosen theatrical performance, nor does it deny bodies. It argues that speech, dress, gesture and institutional classification repeatedly constitute intelligible gendered subjects. Because the norm requires repetition, failed or subversive repetition can disclose its contingency. This helps feminism explain why hierarchy survives without a single commanding patriarch and why apparently personal conduct is politically regulated. Further development: Butler also challenges the standard textbook picture in which a stable biological sex merely receives a cultural gender. The categories through which bodies are recognised are themselves organised by discourse and power. Critics reply that this approach may understate material constraints, reproductive embodiment and durable institutions. Butler's contribution remains strongest as an account of naturalisation: norms appear inevitable because repetition conceals their history. Political feminism can accept this insight while retaining empirically usable categories for law and mobilisation. The category must function as a revisable coalition rather than an essence that predetermines all members. Critical evaluation: The category problem is serious: if 'woman' is wholly an unstable effect of discourse, the subject of anti-discrimination claims appears to dissolve. Yet temporary categories can harden and exclude those who fit badly. Conclusion: Butler strengthens feminism by exposing the repeated practices that naturalise gender, but political action still requires provisional categories whose strategic use must remain open to internal criticism and revision.

Why this earns marks: it obeys critically examine instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Judith Butler, Core and Performativity), converts that evidence into analysis of examine Judith Butler's account of gender performativity and the category problem it creates for feminism, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Butler strengthens feminism by exposing the repeated practices that naturalise gender, but political action still requires provisional categories whose strategic use must remain open to internal criticism and revision. At 247 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks

Question: Evaluate the feminist critique of the public-private divide with reference to Carole Pateman and Susan Moller Okin. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive evaluate requires the answer to apply a stated criterion and give a graded verdict, not a summary. Fix the boundary of the feminist critique of the public-private divide with reference to Carole Pateman and Susan Moller Okin in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Feminist, Core and Carole Pateman's, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Pateman and Okin show that public equality cannot rest on unexamined private subordination;.

Model answer (238 words):

Introduction: Feminist political theory argues that public freedom is incomplete when the household and intimate sphere are treated as naturally private and exempt from justice. Core analysis: Carole Pateman's *The Sexual Contract* reconstructs classical contract theory as resting on an unspoken structure of male access to women's bodies and labour. The thesis is interpretive, not a claim that an actual historical contract was signed. Susan Moller Okin argues that theories such as Rawls's insufficiently examine the family as a site where gendered labour produces unequal time, income and opportunity. The apparently neutral citizen entering public life may therefore carry resources made possible by another person's unpaid care and dependence. Further development: The critique also changes the meaning of citizenship. If one citizen's public participation depends on another's unequal domestic burden, formally identical rights conceal unequal effective freedom. Indian application should remain conceptual: women's education, property control, political representation and care work illustrate the conversion problem without importing unverified statistics or legal detail. Critics may defend family autonomy and warn against bureaucratic intrusion. The feminist reply is that autonomy itself requires non-domination, material exit and shared responsibility. The answer is not abolition of privacy, but justice-sensitive background conditions: freedom from violence, fair care burdens, economic security and genuine exit. Conclusion: Pateman and Okin show that public equality cannot rest on unexamined private subordination; a defensible settlement protects personal intimacy while subjecting coercive dependency and gendered background conditions to justice.

Why this earns marks: it obeys evaluate instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Feminist, Core and Carole Pateman's), converts that evidence into analysis of the feminist critique of the public-private divide with reference to Carole Pateman and Susan Moller Okin, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Pateman and Okin show that public equality cannot rest on unexamined private subordination;. At 238 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks

Question: Is feminism best understood as a project of equality, empowerment or social transformation? Discuss. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive is requires the answer to take a side, defend it and concede the strongest point against it. Fix the boundary of feminism best understood as a project of equality, empowerment or social transformation? Discuss in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Equality, Core and Empowerment, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Feminism is most adequately understood as an integrated project: equality supplies status and rights, empowerment supplies effective agency, and social transformation removes the institutions and norms that repeatedly reproduce subordination.

Model answer (243 words):

Introduction: Equality, empowerment and social transformation name different levels of the feminist project rather than mutually exclusive goals. Core analysis: Equality attacks unjust status distinctions through rights, education, property, work and representation. Empowerment asks whether women possess the resources, capabilities, voice and control needed to use formal rights. Transformation goes further by changing gendered socialisation, care arrangements, labour markets, family authority and cultural norms that reproduce dependence. Liberal feminism foregrounds equal access; radical feminism exposes sexual and reproductive power; Marxist and socialist feminism connect household labour with political economy; intersectionality asks which women benefit or remain marginalised. Further development: The historical sequence illustrates the integration. Early rights feminism removed formal exclusions; later movements showed that suffrage and legal personality did not automatically redistribute authority, labour or recognition. Pateman and Okin relocate justice within the background institutions of contract and family. Butler reveals

the repeated norms through which identities are naturalised, while Crenshaw's intersectionality tests whether a universal category conceals differentiated disadvantage. A current comparative anchor also supports the distinction: the 2026 UN summary of the IPU's 2025 report found higher average women's representation in chambers with legislated quotas, but representation alone does not establish equal influence or freedom from intimidation. A defensible feminism therefore joins equal status, substantive capability and democratic transformation. Conclusion: Feminism is most adequately understood as an integrated project: equality supplies status and rights, empowerment supplies effective agency, and social transformation removes the institutions and norms that repeatedly reproduce subordination.

Why this earns marks: it obeys is instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Equality, Core and Empowerment), converts that evidence into analysis of feminism best understood as a project of equality, empowerment or social transformation? Discuss, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Feminism is most adequately understood as an integrated project: equality supplies status and rights, empowerment supplies effective agency, and social transformation removes the institutions and norms that repeatedly reproduce subordination. At 243 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Political Theory | **Tier:** Advanced enrichment | **Exam relevance:** UPSC Prelims and GS Mains, primarily GS-II. This universal label means enrichment beyond a core GS answer and never a separate-paper classification. **Core area:** From the sex-gender distinction to competing feminist explanations of subordination, power and equality. **Grounded in:** O. P. Gauba, *An Introduction to Political Theory*, Fifth Edition (2009), Ch.2, PDF pp.84-93. **Source edition/cutoff:** Fifth Edition (2009); no post-2009 fact is assumed unless independently dated and tagged **CURRENT:**. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference/synthesis | **CURRENT:** = dated current anchor | **WRONG:** = trap/misattribution. *Companion:* Political-Theory/basic/06_Feminism-Sex-and-Gender.md.

1. One-screen advanced map

```
patriarchy
->
sex (biology) != gender (social meaning)
->
women's inequality is culturally organized
->
early equal-rights feminism
  -> liberal feminism
  -> radical feminism
  -> socialist feminism
->
citizenship, representation and justice questions
```

- ANALYSIS: The advanced move is from "women lack rights" to "social power is gender-coded even after formal rights are granted."

2. Scope, assumptions and conceptual boundary

- FACT: This file remains theory-centred: patriarchy, sex/gender, streams of feminism and the status of women in public life. (PDF pp.84-93)
- FACT: Gauba includes many numerical and representational illustrations from the late twentieth century; they must be treated as historical/book-period material rather than current data. (PDF pp.86, 91-93)
- ANALYSIS: The point here is not current gender-data reporting, but the conceptual tools needed to analyse gendered inequality.

3. Direct-book argument reconstruction

- FACT: Step 1: feminism is introduced as protest against the inferior status of women created by patriarchy. (PDF p.84)
- FACT: Step 2: Gauba separates sex from gender so that biological difference is not confused with social hierarchy. (PDF pp.84-86)
- FACT: Step 3: masculinity and femininity are shown as culturally coded patterns that reproduce male dominance. (PDF p.85)
- FACT: Step 4: using Rousseau's natural/conventional inequality distinction, Gauba shows gender inequality to be socially alterable. (PDF p.86)
- FACT: Step 5: early feminism is reconstructed through Wollstonecraft and Mill as a demand for rights, education, property and civic equality. (PDF p.88)
- FACT: Step 6: contemporary feminism is classified into liberal, radical and socialist strands. (PDF pp.88-90)
- FACT: Step 7: Gauba then extends the issue from rights to representation, citizenship and gender justice. (PDF pp.90-93)

4. Definitions and distinctions

- FACT: **Patriarchy**: male domination extending from household authority into labour market and public life. (PDF p.84)
- FACT: **Sex**: biological division of humans into male and female. (PDF pp.84-85)
- FACT: **Gender**: the cultural organization of expectations, roles and status attached to sex. (PDF pp.84-85)
- FACT: **Masculinity / femininity**: socially coded personality-traits and behaviours that naturalize domination/submission. (PDF p.85)
- FACT: **Natural inequality / conventional inequality**: Rousseau's distinction used by Gauba to show that gender hierarchy belongs largely to the second category. (PDF p.86)
- FACT: **Equal rights view vs compensatory-equality view**: one stresses same laws, the other supports differentiated protections and representation-enhancing measures. (PDF pp.92-93)

5. Thinker-by-thinker positions

- FACT: **Mary Wollstonecraft**: rejects female inferiority and insists that women, as rational beings, deserve education, property and civic rights. (PDF p.88)
- FACT: **J.S. Mill**: argues that women are not less talented than men and should enjoy full legal and political equality. (PDF pp.84, 88)
- FACT: **Shulamith Firestone**: radical feminist who treats reproductive biology as the ultimate historical basis of female subordination and sees technology as enabling escape from that dependence. (PDF p.89)
- FACT: **Kate Millett**: reads male-female relations as political power relations sustained by ideology, authority and economic force. (PDF p.89)
- FACT: **Sheila Rowbotham**: socialist feminist who ties women's liberation to anti-capitalist struggle and the recovery of women's hidden history. (PDF pp.89-90)
- ANALYSIS: Together these thinkers move the debate from rights-based equality, to patriarchy as power, to patriarchy-plus-capitalism as a combined structure.

6. Competing perspectives

- FACT: **Liberal feminism**: focuses on equal opportunity and the removal of formal discrimination. (PDF p.88)
- FACT: **Radical feminism**: insists that women's oppression is primary and cannot be dissolved into race or class alone. (PDF p.89)
- FACT: **Socialist feminism**: combines patriarchal analysis with Marxist class analysis. (PDF pp.89-90)
- ANALYSIS: Liberal feminism asks whether barriers are open; radical feminism asks who holds power over bodies and sexuality; socialist feminism asks how capitalism and patriarchy reinforce each other.

- ANALYSIS: For UPSC, the richest contrast is between formal equality, sexual power and structural political economy.

7. Internal debates and criticisms

- FACT: Gauba's own presentation shows that formal rights do not exhaust the feminist question because representation and public participation remain unequal even after suffrage. (PDF pp.91-93)
- FACT: Firestone's account gives biology a very strong explanatory role, but that is one radical position, not a universal feminist doctrine. (PDF p.89)
- FACT: Socialist feminism widens explanation but risks submerging specifically gendered experiences inside general anti-capitalist politics unless carefully handled. (inferred from PDF pp.89-90)
- ANALYSIS: The enduring debate is whether patriarchy is best seen as a legal exclusion, a sexual power system, or a system intertwined with class and labour.
- WRONG: Treating any one school as "the" feminist position produces caricature and weak answers.

8. Comparative matrix

Issue	Liberal feminism	Radical feminism	Socialist feminism
Main problem	FACT: Formal exclusion and discriminatory barriers. (PDF p.88)	FACT: Patriarchal sexual power and subordination. (PDF p.89)	FACT: Combined effect of patriarchy and capitalism. (PDF pp.89-90)
Key thinkers in Gauba	FACT: Wollstonecraft, Mill. (PDF p.88)	FACT: Firestone, Millett. (PDF p.89)	FACT: Rowbotham. (PDF pp.89-90)
View of equality	FACT: Equal opportunity and equal rights. (PDF p.88)	FACT: Deep restructuring of sex-power relations. (PDF p.89)	FACT: Equality requires transforming labour, family and class relations. (PDF pp.89-90)
Main analytical lens	FACT: Law, education, profession, representation. (PDF p.88)	FACT: Reproduction, ideology, domination. (PDF p.89)	FACT: Wage labour, domestic labour, history of oppression. (PDF pp.89-90)
Major risk in exam answers	WRONG: Reducing feminism to legal reform alone.	WRONG: Generalizing Firestone's biological emphasis to all feminism.	WRONG: Collapsing gender into class and losing feminist specificity.

9. Application without current-affairs dependence

- ANALYSIS: If asked why equal voting rights did not automatically create equal political power, use Gauba's move from citizenship-in-law to actual representation.
- ANALYSIS: If asked whether social roles are natural, use sex/gender and natural/conventional inequality to show why many hierarchies are alterable.
- ANALYSIS: If asked to compare feminist schools, organize the answer by obstacle identified: law, patriarchy or capitalism-plus-patriarchy.
- ANALYSIS: A timeless example is the difference between biological maternity and the culturally enforced idea that only women should bear domestic-care burdens.

10. UPSC answer-engine prompts

- ANALYSIS: **Prompt 1:** Distinguish sex from gender and explain why the distinction matters politically.
- ANALYSIS: **Prompt 2:** Why is patriarchy a political category and not merely a family arrangement?
- ANALYSIS: **Prompt 3:** Compare liberal, radical and socialist feminism with one thinker each.
- ANALYSIS: **Prompt 4:** Why is formal citizenship insufficient from a feminist standpoint?
- ANALYSIS: **Mini spine:** define patriarchy -> sex/gender distinction -> one historical rights thinker -> three schools -> dated-data caution -> conclusion on justice.

11. Cross-links and exclusions

- FACT: Foundation companion: Political-Theory/basic/06_Feminism-Sex-and-Gender.md.
- FACT: Use Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md for the cross-topic matrix on ideology, power and justice.
- FACT: Use Political-Theory/README.md for the mapped continuities toward state, power, citizenship and justice.
- FACT: For cross-syllabus reinforcement, see Philosophy/paper-2/socio-political/Gender-Discrimination.md and Philosophy/paper-2/socio-political/Political-Ideologies.md.
- FACT: For constitutional-rights application, use Polity/advanced/07_Fundamental-Rights.md.
- FACT: Topic-map continuities especially point toward Political-Theory/advanced/13_Diverse-Perspectives-on-the-State.md (feminist state), Political-Theory/advanced/15_Power-Authority-and-Legitimacy.md (gendered power), Political-Theory/advanced/16_Citizenship-and-Its-Critiques.md (feminist citizenship) and Political-Theory/advanced/20_Diverse-Perspectives-on-Justice.md (feminist justice).
- WRONG: Do not turn this into a current-data note; the assigned task is political theory, not present-day gender indicators.

12. Factual-risk checks

- WRONG: Gauba's 1980 UN statistic on women's work, income and property is a dated historical citation and must not be presented as current fact. (PDF p.86)
- WRONG: The sentence that the condition remained unchanged "today" is itself book-period framing and must not be repeated as a present-day claim. (PDF p.86)
- WRONG: Representation percentages for Western Europe, the UK, the US and Scandinavian legislatures are late-twentieth-century illustrations, not current figures. (PDF pp.91-92)
- WRONG: Firestone's biology-centred account is a radical-feminist position, not feminism's consensus. (PDF p.89)
- WRONG: The 1995 UNDP GDI/GEM references are historical illustrations inside a 2009 text and should be labelled accordingly if used. (PDF pp.92-93)

13. Sources, metadata and tags

- FACT: Primary source used directly: O. P. Gauba, *An Introduction to Political Theory*, Fifth Edition (2009), Ch.2, PDF pp.84-93.
- FACT: Key anchors: feminism, patriarchy and sex/gender distinction (PDF pp.84-86); socialization and rights history (PDF pp.87-88); liberal/radical/socialist feminism (PDF pp.88-90); citizenship and representation discussion (PDF pp.90-93).
- ANALYSIS: Tags: #PoliticalTheory #Advanced #Feminism #Patriarchy #GenderJustice #Citizenship #Representation.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Concept / thinker	Exam-ready formulation
Feminism	concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.
Patriarchy	literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.
Sex	biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.
Gender	culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.

Concept / thinker	Exam-ready formulation
Gender inequality	a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change.
Feminist theory	advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.
Sex vs gender	sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.
Natural inequality vs conventional inequality	Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category.
Legal equality vs substantive equality	early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power.
Equal treatment vs compensatory support	Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.
Mary Wollstonecraft	argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.
J.S. Mill	argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights.

- Key anchors: feminism, patriarchy, sex-gender distinction (PDF pp.84-86); socialization and inequality (PDF pp.86-87); Wollstonecraft, Mill and three streams of feminism (PDF pp.88-90).
- Objection: if gender is entirely performative/socially constructed (Butler), feminism loses a stable category of "woman" around which to organise and to claim rights.
- "Discuss/Examine feminism as a critique of patriarchy" -> needs both diagnosis (what patriarchy is, how gender is produced) and the feminist reply; do not describe patriarchy without the feminist response.
- Thesis (1-2 lines): feminism protests patriarchal subordination via the sex/gender distinction; formal legal equality alone is insufficient.
- Gauba treats feminism as a protest against the inferior status assigned to women by patriarchy, not as a denial that biological differences exist. (PDF pp.84-86)
- The sex-gender distinction is central for answering why inequality can be socially constructed even when biological difference is real. (PDF pp.84-86)
- The three streams of feminism provide a compact framework for PSIR and GS-II answers on equality, citizenship and justice. (PDF pp.88-90)
- Feminism: concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex. (PDF p.84)
- Gender: culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men. (PDF pp.84-85)
- Gender inequality: a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change. (PDF p.86)
- Gauba starts by defining feminism as resistance to unjust female subordination produced by patriarchy. (PDF p.84)
- He then distinguishes sex from gender so that biological difference is separated from socially assigned inferiority. (PDF pp.84-86)
- Trap repair: Sex and gender mean the same thing. -> Gauba makes the distinction foundational: sex is biological, gender is cultural. (PDF pp.84-86)
- Trap repair: All feminism says women are biologically determined. -> Firestone's reproductive-biology argument is one radical-feminist position, not feminism's consensus. (PDF p.89)
- Trap repair: If women receive equal legal rights, feminism has no further issue. -> Gauba shows later feminism asking about representation, social status and unequal participation in public power. (PDF pp.91-93)

- Trap repair: Old statistics in the book can be quoted as present reality. -> The 1980 UN figure and book-era representation data are historical and must not be presented as current fact. (PDF pp.86, 91-93)

1. Define the exact doctrine or controversy in the question.
2. State a qualified thesis before narration begins.
3. Reconstruct premises, mechanism and conclusion.
4. Add named thinkers and one precise distinction.
5. Present the strongest objection, reply and residual limitation.
6. End with a graded verdict tied to the directive.

GS ownership and final answer route

- **Topic boundary:** patriarchy, sex/gender and liberal, radical and socialist feminism.
- **Exam identity:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only; primarily GS-II conceptual foundations.
- **Evidence rule:** claim -> named thinker/example -> what it proves -> limitation.
- **PYQ rule:** only directly verified Prelims/GS Mains questions may be owned; otherwise use labelled original practice.
- **Advanced rule:** Advanced enrichment is useful for qualification but unnecessary for a competent core GS answer.